



Figure 1: One-on-one death match between Krish and Shona

you'd be killed even before you blinked an eye. In case you haven't noticed, the tag line of the game reads 'Jumping the Gun'.

The default inventory is a pistol and wooden mallet. Other collectible weapons can be reloaded by walking over them. The same goes for life and shield. While the mallet proves very effective during close combat, it is your instincts and reflexes that save you if your opponent has picked up the katana or laser rifle. The game is pretty much in instagib mode unless the weapons are lost.

'Hooks' and 'double-jump' help fast manoeuvres and in dodging attacks.

The game allows chat (useful to taunt your opponents) and an 'emoticon' system to convey your mood to other players. The current supported game modes are *Death Match*, *Capture the Flag* and *Team Death Match*. You can also choose to be a spectator and for people who love one-on-one gaming, you can modify the TDM to allow only two active players.

A little practice on my LAN server and then a few matches on Internet servers were enough to make me addicted to Teeworlds.

Interface

The game menu sports a nice tabbed interface to choose between the Internet and LAN servers. The settings allow you to choose your player skin including options for custom colours; the controls feel like a standard FPS game; the graphics options enable choosing from different resolutions – like the full screen or disabling high resolution details if your graphics card isn't for the game.

There is no joystick support yet, and unfortunately, it is not on the developers' priority list either. Thankfully, re-mapping of keys is allowed.

The sound is satisfactory. Some improvements could

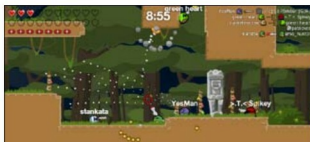


Figure 2: Survival of the swifttest



Figure 3: Snowy grave

include ensuring the pistol and rifle do not sound so similar, and adding Japanese style background music at least until someone loses the katana.

The game currently supports up to 16 players, and has a voting and a banning system. The game menu has filtering options and a very strong search feature, which can get a server list for any existing player name.

Being a free software project, Teeworlds has many custom maps and mods, a support forum on its website [www.teeworlds.com/forum], an IRC channel [teeworlds.on.irc.quakenet.org] and is believed to have clans who battle out each other from time to time.

Oh, and as for my final words: this is an innovative, surprising and an addictive game that's easy to learn and real fun to play. 

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